

Our Lady of Lourdes Steelstown



Sunday 6 September
23rd Sunday Of The Year

Creation is God's work. Before humanity was, the rest of creation came into being. The earth and her creatures – indeed the whole cosmos – have beauty, dignity and meaning before human presence.

So to nurture awe at the wonder of creation is part of our calling. Look up into the skies, walk in the fields, stand at the ocean's edge. Everything belongs, everything has beauty! The garden is such an insightful model for our care of creation.. Our call is to be good gardeners, thoughtful, alert and diligent, working with the soil and with the rhythm of the seasons, caring for the creatures who find home and shelter in the garden.

Ian Adams



SAFEGUARDING NOTICE

If you have any concerns with regard to Safeguarding children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O’Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at +447596 500 793 or at dlp@derrydiocese.org. For emergencies please contact PSNI Tel 101 or Social Services Western HSC Trust Tel +442871314090 (Ask for Duty Social Worker).

Additional contact numbers:

Northern Ireland: PSNI Tel 101 or Social Services Western HSC Trust Tel +442871314090 (Ask for Duty Social Worker)

Republic of Ireland: Garda Siochana, Buncrana +353749320540 or Letterkenny HQ +353749167100 TUSLA Family and Child Agency, Buncrana +353749320420 or Letterkenny +353749123672.



COUPLES PLANNING TO GET MARRIED

If you live in this parish and plan to marry here or in another Catholic Church then you require marriage papers from this parish. You must give at least three months notice of your intention to marry. The following documentation will be required: a recent copy of your Baptism Certificate from the Parish of your Baptism; and possibly a letter of freedom.

All couples are required to prepare for the Sacrament of Marriage. Accord offers marriage preparation and can be contacted at 71362475 or online www.accord-ni.co.uk. Places available on the November 20th/21st course. This course is in person and Venue: Everglades Hotel Derry.

All couples living in this Parish and planning to marry here or elsewhere are please asked to contact the parish office to make arrangements for the completion of the paperwork.



BOOKSTAND

There is a variety of books and cards on sale at the back of the Church.

Signed Mass cards and various Mass bouquet cards are also available from the Parochial House during office hours.

PARISH OFFICE

The Parish Office is open between 9am and 3pm Wednesday to Friday.

Please bring Passport Application Forms, make requests for Baptismal Certificates etc during office hours.

Please do not bring forms to the Parochial House on Sundays.

SEASON OF CREATION 2026 The Season of Creation takes place from 1 September to 4 October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, Living Water, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

BLESSING OF BIKERS AND MOTORCYCLES Will take place next Sunday, 13 September, in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1.30pm. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, Dungiven, at 11.30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

DONEGAL GROUP 173 RISE AND SHINE TRUST (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26 September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal McKeown Diocese of Derry and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

HOST FOR HOSPICE October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your free host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice, on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

NOT DEAD YET UK have provided postcards you can send to your MP to ask them to vote NO to assisted suicide in the vote in the House of Commons on 11 September. Please take action now - collect a red and white postcard, fill out your details, add a stamp and post it to your MP today!

HLI IRELAND Fr Lawrence Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry, on Tuesday 29 September at 6.45pm, with a First Class Relic of St Thérèse. Free admission.

POPE'S PRAYER INTENTION FOR SEPTEMBER

For the care of water

Let us pray for a just and sustainable management of water, a vital resource, so that everyone may have equal access to it.

Our Lady of Lourdes Steelstown



OFFICE: Wednesdays to Fridays: 9am to 3pm
Tel: 028 7135 1718
Email: steelstown@derrydiocese.org
culmoreparish@derrydiocese.org

PRIEST: Rev. Declan McGeehan
Email: declan.mcgeeahan@derrydiocese.org
Emergency Tel.: 073 5238 7817 (*urgent sick calls only*)

MASS TIMES:
Sunday: 09:00am; 11:00am and 12:15pm
Monday: 07:45am; 7:00pm
Tuesday - Thursday: 07:45am and 10:00am
Friday: 07:45am
Saturday: 10:00am; **Vigil Mass:** 6:30pm

CONFESSIONS:
Sunday: 09:45am - 10:50am
Monday: 6:30pm - 6:55pm
Tuesday: 08:10am - 08:30am
Thursday: 09:30am - 09:55am
Saturday: 10:30am-11:30am; &, 5:45pm - 6:20pm

ANNIVERSARIES

Please pray for the repose of the souls of:
May Doherty; Tom Casey; Noah Karran;
Kevin Johnston; Megan Tyre;
Mary McDevitt; Kevin McDevitt;
Rita Nelis; Paddy Nelis;
Roseleen Meenan and William Falconer.

COLLECTION

Last Sunday's Collection amounted to £3,655.00.
Thank you for your generosity.

RETIRED PRIEST'S COLLECTION

Will be taken up at all Masses next weekend, 12/13 September.
There is a special envelope in your collection envelope box.

SACRAMENT OF MARRIAGE

We congratulate Tiegán and Sean who recently celebrated the sacrament of marriage here in Our Lady of Lourdes, Steelstown.

ANNIVERSARY AND MONTH'S MIND MASSES

To book a Mass for an anniversary or month's mind please contact the parish office by telephone on 02871 351718 or by email at steelstown@derrydiocese.org.

The daytime Masses will only be offered for one intention but the evening Masses, Monday at 7pm and Saturday 6.30pm, can be offered for more than one intention.

VOCATIONS

Anyone interested in serving the diocese of Derry as a priest should contact their local priest(s) and/or the diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, PP, Bellaghy, at pgoh2111@gmail.com.